English Drills 1 to 4

Two grammar drills (25 questions, 15 minutes each) and two comprehension drills (five passages, 25 questions, 25 minutes each). Answer keys at the end.

What this is. Drills built from an analysis of the English questions in GPSC papers from 2021 to September 2026. Drill 1 follows the 5-question grammar blocks of the 2026 papers; Drill 2 covers vocabulary, idioms and usage; Drill 3 uses five real GPSC passages from 2023-24 in the older, vocabulary-heavy pattern; Drill 4 has health and medicine passages in the 2026 pattern, for the Homoeopathic Physician paper. Option E is always "None of the above".

English Drill 1: Grammar in the 2026 pattern

SECTION I | 25 MARKS

English drill: Grammar in the 2026 pattern

1. Choose the correct inverted structure:

A. Under no circumstances did the patient should be left alone.
B. Under no circumstances the patient should be left alone.
C. Under no circumstances should the patient be left alone.
D. Under no circumstances should be left the patient alone.
E. None of the above

2. Choose the correct option: “Scarcely had I reached home _____ it started raining.”

A. and
B. when
C. then
D. than
E. None of the above

3. Choose the correct option: “I would rather you _____ the report today.”

A. submit
B. will submit
C. have submitted
D. submitted
E. None of the above

4. Choose the correct conditional sentence:

A. If I had known about the strike, I will have stayed at home.
B. Had I knew about the strike, I would have stayed at home.
C. Had I known about the strike, I would stay at home yesterday.
D. Had I known about the strike, I would have stayed at home.
E. None of the above

5. Choose the correct sentence:

A. He is more taller than I.
B. He is tallest than I.
C. He is taller than I.
D. He is taller than me am.
E. None of the above

6. Identify the error: “Bread and butter are his daily breakfast.”

A. Bread and butter
B. are
C. his
D. daily breakfast
E. None of the above

7. Find the error: “The number of patients have increased this month.”

A. The number
B. of patients
C. have
D. this month
E. None of the above

8. Identify the error: “She has went to the dispensary.”

A. She
B. has
C. went
D. to the dispensary
E. None of the above

9. Spot the error: “She is senior than me by two years.”

A. She is
B. senior
C. than
D. by two years
E. None of the above

10. Identify the error: “Mathematics are taught by Mr Naik.”

A. Mathematics
B. are
C. taught
D. by Mr Naik
E. None of the above

11. Choose the correct passive construction: “The nurse is dressing the wound.”

A. The wound is being dressed by the nurse.
B. The wound was being dressed by the nurse.
C. The wound is been dressed by the nurse.
D. The wound is dressed by the nurse.
E. None of the above

12. Choose the correct passive construction: “You must follow these rules.”

A. These rules must followed.
B. These rules must be follow.
C. These rules must be followed.
D. These rules must have followed.
E. None of the above

13. Select the correct indirect speech: He said, “I will come tomorrow.”

A. He said that I would come the next day.
B. He said that he would come the next day.
C. He said that he would come yesterday.
D. He said that he will come tomorrow.
E. None of the above

14. Select the correct indirect speech: She said, “What a beautiful garden!”

A. She said what a beautiful garden it was!
B. She asked that it was a beautiful garden.
C. She exclaimed that what a beautiful garden.
D. She exclaimed that it was a very beautiful garden.
E. None of the above

15. Choose the correct transformation: “No other city in India is as large as Mumbai.” (comparative degree)

A. Mumbai is larger than any other city in India.
B. Mumbai is the largest than other cities in India.
C. Mumbai is larger than any city in India.
D. Mumbai is as large as any other city in India.
E. None of the above

16. Choose the correct tense: “I _____ for an hour when the doctor finally called me.”

A. had been waiting
B. am waiting
C. have been waiting
D. was waited
E. None of the above

17. Choose the correct modal: “You _____ not park here; it is a no-parking zone.”

A. might
B. must
C. need
D. would
E. None of the above

18. Choose the correct tense: “Water _____ at 100 °C at sea level.”

A. has boiled
B. boiled
C. is boiling
D. boils
E. None of the above

19. Choose the correct modal: “She _____ have reached by now; she left two hours ago.”

A. need
B. should
C. must not
D. can't
E. None of the above

20. Choose the correct tense: “He _____ the files when the auditor walked in.”

A. had been checked
B. checked
C. has checked
D. was checking
E. None of the above

21. Identify the clause type: “I know that he is innocent.”

A. Adverb clause
B. Relative clause
C. Noun clause
D. Adjective clause
E. None of the above

22. Identify the clause type: “We left before the storm broke.”

A. Adverb clause of reason
B. Noun clause
C. Adjective clause
D. Adverb clause of time
E. None of the above

23. Choose the correct preposition: “The medicine is good _____ cough.”

A. to
B. against
C. for
D. with
E. None of the above

24. Choose the correct preposition: “He prevented me _____ going out.”

A. for
B. to
C. from
D. of
E. None of the above

25. Identify the conjunction relationship: “He was tired, so he went to bed early.”

A. Result
B. Purpose
C. Condition
D. Contrast
E. None of the above

English Drill 2: Vocabulary, idioms and usage

SECTION I | 25 MARKS

English drill: Vocabulary, idioms and usage

1. Choose the word closest in meaning to “prolific”:

A. careless
B. productive
C. famous
D. lazy
E. None of the above

2. Choose the word closest in meaning to “meticulous”:

A. lazy
B. careful
C. careless
D. hasty
E. None of the above

3. Choose the word closest in meaning to “benevolent”:

A. selfish
B. angry
C. cruel
D. kind
E. None of the above

4. Choose the word closest in meaning to “transient”:

A. strong
B. permanent
C. transparent
D. temporary
E. None of the above

5. Choose the word closest in meaning to “impede”:

A. obstruct
B. speed up
C. explain
D. assist
E. None of the above

6. Choose the word opposite in meaning to “frugal”:

A. extravagant
B. careful
C. simple
D. thrifty
E. None of the above

7. Choose the word opposite in meaning to “scarcity”:

A. abundance
B. poverty
C. dearth
D. shortage
E. None of the above

8. Choose the word opposite in meaning to “convergence”:

A. union
B. meeting
C. divergence
D. junction
E. None of the above

9. Choose the word opposite in meaning to “artificial”:

A. false
B. synthetic
C. natural
D. man-made
E. None of the above

10. Choose the word opposite in meaning to “heed”:

A. notice
B. observe
C. ignore
D. obey
E. None of the above

11. Choose the meaning of the idiom “to bury the hatchet”:

A. to start a quarrel
B. to hide a weapon
C. to make peace
D. to dig a grave
E. None of the above

12. Choose the meaning of the idiom “a blessing in disguise”:

A. a hidden gift
B. a false friend
C. something that seems bad but turns out good
D. a religious ceremony
E. None of the above

13. Choose the meaning of the idiom “to let the cat out of the bag”:

A. to set an animal free
B. to reveal a secret
C. to escape punishment
D. to create confusion
E. None of the above

14. Choose the meaning of the idiom “once in a blue moon”:

A. every month
B. suddenly
C. at night
D. very rarely
E. None of the above

15. Choose the correct phrasal verb: “The doctor asked him to _____ smoking.”

A. give away
B. give up
C. give out
D. give in
E. None of the above

16. Choose the correct phrasal verb: “The officer promised to _____ the complaint.”

A. look into
B. look after
C. look up to
D. look down on
E. None of the above

17. Choose the correct phrasal verb: “It took her weeks to _____ the fever.”

A. get along
B. get through to
C. get over
D. get by
E. None of the above

18. Choose the one word for: “a doctor who treats children”

A. paediatrician
B. gynaecologist
C. dermatologist
D. orthopaedist
E. None of the above

19. Choose the one word for: “a disease that spreads over a whole country or the world”

A. epidemic
B. pandemic
C. sporadic
D. endemic
E. None of the above

20. Choose the one word for: “a person who cannot be corrected”

A. incorrigible
B. invincible
C. incurable
D. indelible
E. None of the above

21. Choose the correctly spelt word:

A. acommodation
B. accomodation
C. accommadation
D. accommodation
E. None of the above

22. Choose the correctly spelt word:

A. benefitted
B. benifited
C. beneffited
D. benefited
E. None of the above

23. Identify the figure of speech: “The wind whispered through the trees.”

A. Alliteration
B. Simile
C. Hyperbole
D. Personification
E. None of the above

24. Identify the figure of speech: “The child is the father of the man.”

A. Paradox
B. Antithesis
C. Simile
D. Metaphor
E. None of the above

25. Identify the figure of speech: “He is as brave as a lion.”

A. Metaphor
B. Simile
C. Oxymoron
D. Personification
E. None of the above

English Drill 3: Comprehension: five real GPSC passages

SECTION I | 25 MARKS

English drill: Comprehension: five real GPSC passages

Passage 1. Read the passage and answer questions 1 to 5.

Most malnutrition is invisible. Consistent undernutrition, together with bouts of infection and diarrhoea, can retard growth so gradually as to go unnoticed by the mother. Unless a child is seriously underweight or shows obvious signs of malnutrition (listlessness, discoloured hair, irritability, frequent crying, distended stomach) his condition of undernutrition may not be visible to the mother. For timely prevention of malnutrition, the UNICEF has been using the simple inexpensive method of growth monitoring charts which help mothers see whether or not their children are growing and gaining weight correctly, and thus can be an effective aid to sound child health and nutrition. The first requirement for children and adults who are undernourished and living at subsistence level is adequate quantity of food. The next is nutritious food, containing all the elements necessary to support life and maintain good health.

1. The passage implies that, when early signs of malnutrition go unnoticed, the immediate fallout is that this

A. hinders the prevention of malnutrition
B. leads to undernutrition in the long run
C. conceals the condition of undernutrition
D. leads to infection and diarrhoea
E. None of the above

2. Listlessness, discoloured hair, irritability, frequent crying and a distended stomach in a child indicate

A. infection only
B. undernutrition
C. normal growth
D. subsistence
E. None of the above

3. Which word from the passage means "to delay or slow down the development of something"?

A. retard
B. bouts
C. distended
D. malnutrition
E. None of the above

4. The term "subsistence" in the passage means

A. the minimal resources needed to survive
B. a kind of matter with uniform properties
C. food regarded as nourishment
D. to continue to exist
E. None of the above

5. What simple method has UNICEF used for timely prevention of malnutrition?

A. Vitamin injections
B. Free meals
C. Hospital screening
D. Growth monitoring charts
E. None of the above

Passage 2. Read the passage and answer questions 6 to 10.

The World Health Organization is popularly known as W.H.O. in brief. It is a specialized agency of the United Nations and was established in 1948. International health workers can be seen working in all kinds of surroundings: in deserts, jungles, mountains, coconut groves, and rice fields. They help the sick to attain health and the healthy to maintain their health. This global health team helps the local health workers in stopping the spread of what are called the communicable diseases, like cholera. These diseases can be spread from one country to another and so can be a threat to world health. W.H.O. assists different national health authorities not only in controlling diseases but also in preventing them. Total prevention is possible in a number of ways, such as vaccination and spraying of houses with substances which kill disease-carrying insects.

6. Which word in the passage means "contagious or infectious"?

A. communicable
B. cholera
C. insects
D. disease
E. None of the above

7. "It is a specialized agency of the United Nations." Here "specialized" means

A. extraordinary
B. made suitable for a particular purpose
C. expert
D. uncommon
E. None of the above

8. "W.H.O. assists national health authorities not only in controlling diseases but also in preventing them." This implies that W.H.O.

A. helps more in control than prevention
B. helps both in controlling and in preventing diseases
C. helps only where prevention failed
D. helps many others
E. None of the above

9. In "They help the sick to attain health", "they" refers to

A. the member nations
B. the surroundings
C. deserts and jungles
D. international health workers
E. None of the above

10. Why are communicable diseases a threat to world health, according to the passage?

A. They can spread from one country to another
B. They occur only in jungles
C. W.H.O. cannot control them
D. They cannot be treated
E. None of the above

Passage 3. Read the passage and answer questions 11 to 15.

When talking about overeating, obesity and other conditions arising from affluence and plenty, we may tend to overlook the fact that ours is a country where a large percentage of the population subsists on too little food and hardly gets a square meal a day. Even if meals are available, they lack the essential nutrients such as protein, fats, vitamins and minerals. Millions of Indian children are living in poverty. An estimated three million die every year owing to certain preventable conditions, including malnutrition. Carelessness of parents, unhygienic environment and poor health conditions and malnutrition make children more susceptible to disease. It will shock you to know that a major cause of blindness in India is the lack of vitamin A, which is found in abundance in carrots, leaves of drumstick trees, milk and green leafy vegetables.

11. The last sentence indirectly reveals that a large part of the population lacks

A. knowledge that carrots contain vitamin A
B. the means to afford even an ordinary diet containing vitamin A
C. access to vitamins altogether
D. interest in vitamin A
E. None of the above

12. Even when meals are available, many people

A. remain undernourished
B. die of starvation
C. go blind
D. overeat
E. None of the above

13. Besides parental carelessness and unhygienic surroundings, which other causes of disease in children are named?

A. Lack of schools
B. Overeating and obesity
C. Cold weather
D. Poor health conditions and malnutrition
E. None of the above

14. Which phrase in the passage is the opposite of poverty and scarcity?

A. affluence and plenty
B. preventable conditions
C. overeating, obesity
D. square meal a day
E. None of the above

15. The word "susceptible" as used in the passage means

A. resistant
B. responsive
C. prone
D. deceptive
E. None of the above

Passage 4. Read the passage and answer questions 16 to 20.

Tradition means those ways of thinking and feeling which have come down to us from the past. We still have tremendous faith in the power of goodness. This again has nothing to do with religion. A national leader appealed to a group of dacoits of Madhya Pradesh to give up their criminal lives and start afresh. One by one, they came and laid down their arms. They did not surrender to force but to goodness. This took place in the year 1972, but it could easily be a legend of ancient times. Many people say such a thing could not have happened anywhere else in the world today. Happenings of this kind tell us that ours is a living and growing tradition. It is still taking in new influences and merging them with the old. If this stops, Indian tradition itself will die.

16. The tradition discussed in the passage is

A. Western
B. religious
C. Indian
D. of Madhya Pradesh
E. None of the above

17. Through the example of the dacoits, the passage indirectly implies that

A. they feared the police
B. our tradition has tremendous faith in the power of goodness
C. they surrendered to a leader's appeal only
D. they wanted a fresh start
E. None of the above

18. "It could easily be a legend of ancient times" refers to

A. the dacoits' surrender to goodness rather than force
B. the leader's appeal
C. the leader's goodness
D. our unchanging ancient tradition
E. None of the above

19. According to the passage, Indian tradition lives and grows because

A. it has nothing to do with religion
B. it comes from the past
C. it is unlike any other
D. it absorbs new influences and merges them with the old
E. None of the above

20. The word "legend" as used in the passage means

A. a traditional story, popularly believed but unverified
B. a very famous person
C. an outright lie
D. a notorious dacoit
E. None of the above

Passage 5. Read the passage and answer questions 21 to 25.

Stereotyping is a type of generalization which attributes traits or characteristics to everyone in a large group. People who stereotype tend to have fixed and unbending opinions. They respond to challenges by distorting reality, rather than reconsider their assumptions and conclusions, which they have labelled as the truth. What happens is that the facts are compared to the stereotype and then rejected, because they do not fit the stereotype. Stereotyping is often caused by ethno-centrism. The ramifications of stereotyping are that it forces us to choose sides, causes destructive competition, alienates us from others and leads to narrow thinking. We end up denying dignity to others, whom we stereotype, and generate unhappiness all around us.

21. People who stereotype are NOT likely to

A. treat their opinions as the truth
B. distort reality
C. revisit their assumptions
D. have rigid views
E. None of the above

22. Which phrase means the same as "alienates"?

A. turns towards strangers
B. generates friendliness
C. connects to others
D. encourages estrangement
E. None of the above

23. Which word is closest in meaning to "ramification"?

A. source
B. consequence
C. juncture
D. cause
E. None of the above

24. According to the passage, when facts do not fit a stereotype, people who stereotype

A. reject the facts
B. change the stereotype
C. seek more facts
D. ask others
E. None of the above

25. Stereotyping is undesirable because it

A. denies dignity to others
B. has several harmful consequences
C. comes from ethno-centrism
D. all of these
E. None of the above

English Drill 4: Comprehension: health and medicine passages

SECTION I | 25 MARKS

English drill: Comprehension: health and medicine passages

Passage 1. Read the passage and answer questions 1 to 5.

The distinction between medicines and sensual drugs is simple. Sensual drugs are those that the body has no need for, but that give the user a strong sense of pleasure. Sensual drugs activate the brain’s pleasure centres directly or activate them through chemical mimicry. The brain governs sensations, moods, thoughts and actions, not by a magical process but by an incredibly complex series of chemically regulated controls. These are easily upset by sensual drugs. This disturbance is apparent in the effects of the sensual drugs on the mechanism that controls pleasure and satisfaction. A drug user’s craving for the brain’s pleasure reflexes seems to be weakened by artificial stimulation. Information from the senses still reaches the brain, but the brain is unable to evaluate and interpret it as pleasure. In contrast, naturally attained pleasures enlarge the sense of satisfaction and can be repeated indefinitely.

1. According to the passage, sensual drugs differ from medicines chiefly because

A. they activate the brain's pleasure centres
B. the body has no need for them
C. they upset the brain's controls
D. they are expensive
E. None of the above

2. Which phrase does NOT describe how sensual drugs work, according to the passage?

A. giving a strong sense of pleasure
B. chemical mimicry
C. a magical process
D. artificial stimulation
E. None of the above

3. Why does a drug user stop experiencing ordinary sensations as pleasure?

A. Natural pleasures become harmful
B. The drug blocks all sensation
C. The senses stop sending information
D. The brain can no longer evaluate the information as pleasure
E. None of the above

4. In contrast to drug-induced pleasure, natural pleasures

A. enlarge satisfaction and can be repeated indefinitely
B. disturb mental processes
C. weaken the pleasure reflexes
D. are artificially stimulated
E. None of the above

5. The tone of the passage is best described as

A. explanatory and cautionary
B. humorous
C. indifferent
D. nostalgic
E. None of the above

Passage 2. Read the passage and answer questions 6 to 10.

Antimicrobial resistance (AMR) has been described as a slow-moving pandemic. When bacteria, viruses, fungi and parasites stop responding to the medicines designed to kill them, common infections become difficult or impossible to treat. The crisis is driven less by nature than by human behaviour: antibiotics are often prescribed for viral fevers they cannot cure, sold over the counter without prescription, and used to fatten livestock. Each unnecessary dose gives resistant microbes a chance to survive and multiply. India, with its high burden of infectious disease and easy access to antibiotics, is especially vulnerable. National action plans call for stricter control of sales, better laboratory surveillance and the education of doctors and the public. Yet regulation alone cannot succeed if hospitals remain overcrowded, sanitation remains poor and patients continue to demand a quick cure. Containing AMR therefore requires every prescriber to treat antibiotics as a shared resource that must be preserved for future generations.

6. The passage primarily presents antimicrobial resistance as

A. a serious, human-driven threat to the treatment of infections
B. a rare problem confined to hospitals
C. a natural process that cannot be influenced
D. a problem already solved by new drugs
E. None of the above

7. Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a cause of AMR?

A. Over-the-counter sale without prescription
B. Prescribing antibiotics for viral fevers
C. Excessive use of vaccines
D. Use of antibiotics in livestock
E. None of the above

8. The phrase "slow-moving pandemic" suggests that AMR

A. affects only India
B. spreads only among animals
C. will end soon
D. is a worldwide threat that grows gradually
E. None of the above

9. According to the passage, why can regulation alone not contain AMR?

A. Because overcrowding, poor sanitation and demand for quick cures also drive it
B. Because doctors oppose it
C. Because microbes cannot be studied
D. Because laws are never enforced
E. None of the above

10. The author's overall tone is best described as

A. alarmist and hopeless
B. analytical and cautionary
C. humorous
D. indifferent
E. None of the above

Passage 3. Read the passage and answer questions 11 to 15.

India is unusual in giving official recognition to several systems of medicine. Ayurveda, Yoga and Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha, Sowa-Rigpa and Homoeopathy are grouped under AYUSH and supported by a separate ministry, research councils and a network of dispensaries. Supporters argue that these systems are affordable, culturally familiar and well suited to chronic and lifestyle disorders, where long-term care matters more than dramatic intervention. Integrating AYUSH practitioners into primary health centres could also ease the shortage of doctors in rural areas. Critics, however, point out that the evidence base for many traditional remedies remains thin, and that patients may delay effective treatment for serious illness. The challenge, then, is not to choose one system over another but to build an integrated framework in which each system is used where it works best, supported by rigorous research, clear referral pathways and honest communication with patients.

11. The passage primarily presents AYUSH systems as

A. a replacement for modern medicine
B. officially recognised systems with both strengths and limitations
C. unscientific practices to be abolished
D. systems used only abroad
E. None of the above

12. Which system is NOT named in the passage as part of AYUSH?

A. Unani
B. Acupuncture
C. Sowa-Rigpa
D. Siddha
E. None of the above

13. According to supporters, AYUSH systems are especially suited to

A. chronic and lifestyle disorders
B. infectious epidemics
C. trauma care
D. emergency surgery
E. None of the above

14. What concern do critics raise?

A. AYUSH is not culturally familiar
B. AYUSH is too expensive
C. There are too many AYUSH doctors
D. The evidence for many remedies is thin and patients may delay effective treatment
E. None of the above

15. The author's conclusion is that

A. one system should replace the others
B. patients should choose without guidance
C. an integrated framework, backed by research and referral, is needed
D. AYUSH should be abolished
E. None of the above

Passage 4. Read the passage and answer questions 16 to 20.

Telemedicine promised to carry the specialist to the village. A patient in a remote taluka can now consult a doctor in a city hospital through a video call, share reports instantly and receive a digital prescription. During the pandemic such services kept routine care going when clinics were closed, and government platforms recorded millions of consultations. Yet the technology cannot examine an abdomen or listen to a chest; it depends on a trained health worker at the patient's end and on a reliable internet connection that many villages still lack. Older and less literate patients often find the process confusing, and doctors worry about missing signs that a physical examination would reveal. Telemedicine is therefore best seen not as a substitute for the local clinic but as an extension of it, most useful for follow-up visits, specialist opinions and the management of chronic illness.

16. The passage mainly presents telemedicine as

A. a failed experiment
B. a complete replacement for clinics
C. a service only for cities
D. a useful extension of local care with clear limits
E. None of the above

17. According to the passage, telemedicine cannot

A. perform a physical examination
B. connect villages to city doctors
C. share reports
D. issue digital prescriptions
E. None of the above

18. Which group, according to the passage, often finds telemedicine confusing?

A. Young urban patients
B. Older and less literate patients
C. Health workers
D. Specialists
E. None of the above

19. For which purpose is telemedicine described as most useful?

A. Follow-up visits and chronic illness management
B. Replacing health workers
C. Diagnosing every new illness
D. Emergency surgery
E. None of the above

20. The author's attitude toward telemedicine is

A. uncritically enthusiastic
B. indifferent
C. balanced and practical
D. completely dismissive
E. None of the above

Passage 5. Read the passage and answer questions 21 to 25.

Clinical trials are the bridge between laboratory discovery and bedside treatment. Before a new medicine reaches the market, it must be tested on human volunteers in carefully designed phases that measure safety, dosage and effectiveness. Such research depends on trust. Participants must give informed consent, which means they understand the purpose, risks and benefits of the trial and know that they may withdraw at any time without penalty. In the past, trials conducted among poor and poorly educated populations sometimes exposed people to risks they did not fully understand. Ethics committees, registration of trials and compensation rules were introduced to prevent such abuse. Even so, consent forms written in technical language can turn a safeguard into a formality. Genuine protection requires that information be explained in the participant's own language and that the welfare of the volunteer always outweighs the interests of science or commerce.

21. The passage primarily describes clinical trials as

A. essential research that depends on ethical safeguards
B. a purely commercial activity
C. always harmful to volunteers
D. unnecessary for new medicines
E. None of the above

22. According to the passage, informed consent means that participants

A. are paid for joining
B. understand the purpose, risks and benefits and may withdraw at any time
C. cannot leave once enrolled
D. are chosen by lottery
E. None of the above

23. Which safeguard is NOT mentioned in the passage?

A. Ethics committees
B. Compensation rules
C. Mandatory insurance for doctors
D. Registration of trials
E. None of the above

24. The phrase "turn a safeguard into a formality" implies that consent forms

A. may be signed without real understanding
B. protect only doctors
C. are always useless
D. should be abolished
E. None of the above

25. The author's conclusion is that

A. science must come first
B. trials should be stopped
C. commercial interests should decide trials
D. the welfare of the volunteer must always come first
E. None of the above

ANSWERS

English Drill 1: Grammar in the 2026 pattern: answer key

1	**C**	6	**B**	11	**A**	16	**A**	21	**C**
2	**B**	7	**C**	12	**C**	17	**B**	22	**D**
3	**D**	8	**C**	13	**B**	18	**D**	23	**C**
4	**D**	9	**C**	14	**D**	19	**B**	24	**C**
5	**C**	10	**B**	15	**A**	20	**D**	25	**A**

Explanations

English drill: Grammar in the 2026 pattern

1	**C**	**Under no circumstances should the patient be left alone.** Negative phrase at the start: auxiliary + subject. GPSC-style practice item.
2	**B**	**when** 'Scarcely ... when'. GPSC-style practice item.
3	**D**	**submitted** 'Would rather' + another subject takes the past form. GPSC-style practice item.
4	**D**	**Had I known about the strike, I would have stayed at home.** 'Had I known' = 'If I had known' (third conditional). GPSC-style practice item.
5	**C**	**He is taller than I.** After 'than', 'I' (as in 'than I am') is the formal correct form; GPSC keys follow this. GPSC-style practice item.
6	**B**	**are** Two nouns that name one thing take a singular verb: 'is'. GPSC-style practice item.
7	**C**	**have** 'The number of' is singular ('has'); 'a number of' is plural. GPSC-style practice item.
8	**C**	**went** After 'has', use the past participle: 'has gone'. GPSC-style practice item.
9	**C**	**than** 'Senior', 'junior', 'superior', 'inferior' take 'to': 'senior to me'. GPSC-style practice item.
10	**B**	**are** Subject names ending in -ics take a singular verb: 'is taught'. GPSC-style practice item.
11	**A**	**The wound is being dressed by the nurse.** Present continuous passive: is being + past participle. GPSC-style practice item.
12	**C**	**These rules must be followed.** Modal passive: modal + be + past participle. GPSC-style practice item.
13	**B**	**He said that he would come the next day.** will → would; tomorrow → the next day. GPSC-style practice item.

English drill: Grammar in the 2026 pattern		
14	**D**	**She exclaimed that it was a very beautiful garden.** Exclamations become 'exclaimed that ... very ...'. GPSC-style practice item.
15	**A**	**Mumbai is larger than any other city in India.** Positive → comparative with 'any other'. GPSC-style practice item.
16	**A**	**had been waiting** A continuing action up to a point in the past: past perfect continuous. GPSC-style practice item.
17	**B**	**must** 'Must not' = prohibition. GPSC-style practice item.
18	**D**	**boils** Universal truths take the simple present. GPSC-style practice item.
19	**B**	**should** 'Should have' for an expected result. GPSC-style practice item.
20	**D**	**was checking** An action in progress interrupted by another: past continuous. GPSC-style practice item.
21	**C**	**Noun clause** 'That he is innocent' is the object of 'know'. GPSC-style practice item.
22	**D**	**Adverb clause of time** 'Before the storm broke' tells when. GPSC-style practice item.
23	**C**	**for** 'Good for' (beneficial); 'good at' (skilled). GPSC-style practice item.
24	**C**	**from** 'Prevent from'. GPSC-style practice item.
25	**A**	**Result** 'So' introduces a result. GPSC-style practice item.

ANSWERS

English Drill 2: Vocabulary, idioms and usage: answer key

1	**B**	6	**A**	11	**C**	16	**A**	21	**D**
2	**B**	7	**A**	12	**C**	17	**C**	22	**D**
3	**D**	8	**C**	13	**B**	18	**A**	23	**D**
4	**D**	9	**C**	14	**D**	19	**B**	24	**A**
5	**A**	10	**C**	15	**B**	20	**A**	25	**B**

Explanations

English drill: Vocabulary, idioms and usage

1 **B** **productive**
Prolific = producing much (work, fruit, offspring). GPSC-style practice item.

2 **B** **careful**
Meticulous = showing great attention to detail. GPSC-style practice item.

3 **D** **kind**
Benevolent = well-meaning and kind. GPSC-style practice item.

4 **D** **temporary**
Transient = lasting only a short time. GPSC-style practice item.

5 **A** **obstruct**
Impede = hinder. GPSC-style practice item.

6 **A** **extravagant**
Frugal = sparing with money; opposite: extravagant. GPSC-style practice item.

7 **A** **abundance**
Opposite of scarcity is abundance (plenty). GPSC-style practice item.

8 **C** **divergence**
GPSC asked this pair in 2023. GPSC-style practice item.

9 **C** **natural**
Static vocabulary. GPSC-style practice item.

10 **C** **ignore**
Heed = pay attention to. GPSC-style practice item.

11 **C** **to make peace**
Bury the hatchet = end a quarrel. GPSC-style practice item.

12 **C** **something that seems bad but turns out good**
Standard idiom. GPSC-style practice item.

13 **B** **to reveal a secret**
Standard idiom. GPSC-style practice item.

English drill: Vocabulary, idioms and usage		
14	**D**	**very rarely** Standard idiom. GPSC-style practice item.
15	**B**	**give up** Give up = stop doing; give in = surrender. GPSC-style practice item.
16	**A**	**look into** Look into = investigate. GPSC-style practice item.
17	**C**	**get over** Get over = recover from (GPSC 2026). GPSC-style practice item.
18	**A**	**paediatrician** One-word substitution. GPSC-style practice item.
19	**B**	**pandemic** Epidemic = widespread in one community at a time; endemic = regularly found in an area. GPSC-style practice item.
20	**A**	**incorrigible** One-word substitution. GPSC-style practice item.
21	**D**	**accommodation** Double c, double m. GPSC-style practice item.
22	**D**	**benefited** GPSC 2024 key: 'benefited' (single t). GPSC-style practice item.
23	**D**	**Personification** Human action (whispering) given to the wind. GPSC-style practice item.
24	**A**	**Paradox** An apparently absurd statement that holds a truth (GPSC 2026). GPSC-style practice item.
25	**B**	**Simile** A comparison using 'as' or 'like'. GPSC-style practice item.

ANSWERS

English Drill 3: Comprehension: five real GPSC passages: answer key

1	**C**	6	**A**	11	**B**	16	**C**	21	**C**
2	**B**	7	**B**	12	**A**	17	**B**	22	**D**
3	**A**	8	**B**	13	**D**	18	**A**	23	**B**
4	**A**	9	**D**	14	**A**	19	**D**	24	**A**
5	**D**	10	**A**	15	**C**	20	**A**	25	**D**

Explanations

English drill: Comprehension: five real GPSC passages

1	**C**	**conceals the condition of undernutrition** Inference: undernutrition 'may not be visible to the mother'. GPSC's two versions of this item gave different keys; B follows the text. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Junior Scale Officer), Apr 2024.
2	**B**	**undernutrition** Detail: these are the 'obvious signs of malnutrition'. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Junior Scale Officer), Apr 2024.
3	**A**	**retard** Vocabulary from the passage. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Junior Scale Officer), Apr 2024.
4	**A**	**the minimal resources needed to survive** Vocabulary in context: 'living at subsistence level'. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Junior Scale Officer), Apr 2024.
5	**D**	**Growth monitoring charts** Detail: the fourth sentence. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Junior Scale Officer), Apr 2024.
6	**A**	**communicable** Vocabulary from the passage. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Block Development Officer), Nov 2023.
7	**B**	**made suitable for a particular purpose** Vocabulary in context: an agency with a specific function. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Block Development Officer), Nov 2023.
8	**B**	**helps both in controlling and in preventing diseases** 'Not only … but also' = both. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Block Development Officer), Nov 2023.
9	**D**	**international health workers** Reference question: points back to the previous sentence. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Block Development Officer), Nov 2023.
10	**A**	**They can spread from one country to another** Detail: the sixth sentence. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Block Development Officer), Nov 2023.

English drill: Comprehension: five real GPSC passages

11	**B**	**the means to afford even an ordinary diet containing vitamin A** Inference: vitamin A is in cheap common foods, yet people go blind for lack of it. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Scientific Assistant in Toxicology), Apr 2023.
12	**A**	**remain undernourished** Detail: meals 'lack the essential nutrients'. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Scientific Assistant in Toxicology), Apr 2023.
13	**D**	**Poor health conditions and malnutrition** Detail: the fifth sentence. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Scientific Assistant in Toxicology), Apr 2023.
14	**A**	**affluence and plenty** Antonym from the passage. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Scientific Assistant in Toxicology), Apr 2023.
15	**C**	**prone** Vocabulary in context: 'more susceptible to disease'. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Scientific Assistant in Toxicology), Apr 2023.
16	**C**	**Indian** Detail: the passage ends with 'Indian tradition'. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Junior Scale Officer), Feb 2024.
17	**B**	**our tradition has tremendous faith in the power of goodness** Purpose of the example: it illustrates the second sentence. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Junior Scale Officer), Feb 2024.
18	**A**	**the dacoits' surrender to goodness rather than force** Reference: the event just described. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Junior Scale Officer), Feb 2024.
19	**D**	**it absorbs new influences and merges them with the old** Detail: the second-last sentence. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Junior Scale Officer), Feb 2024.
20	**A**	**a traditional story, popularly believed but unverified** Vocabulary in context. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Junior Scale Officer), Feb 2024.
21	**C**	**revisit their assumptions** They distort reality 'rather than reconsider their assumptions'. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Planning Officer), Apr 2023.
22	**D**	**encourages estrangement** Vocabulary. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Planning Officer), Apr 2023.
23	**B**	**consequence** Vocabulary: a ramification is a (usually unwelcome) consequence. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Planning Officer), Apr 2023.
24	**A**	**reject the facts** Detail: the facts are 'rejected, because they do not fit the stereotype'. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Planning Officer), Apr 2023.
25	**D**	**all of these** All three are stated in the passage. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Planning Officer), Apr 2023.

ANSWERS

English Drill 4: Comprehension: health and medicine passages: answer key

1	**B**	6	**A**	11	**B**	16	**D**	21	**A**
2	**C**	7	**C**	12	**B**	17	**A**	22	**B**
3	**D**	8	**D**	13	**A**	18	**B**	23	**C**
4	**A**	9	**A**	14	**D**	19	**A**	24	**A**
5	**A**	10	**B**	15	**C**	20	**C**	25	**D**

Explanations

English drill: Comprehension: health and medicine passages

1	**B**	**the body has no need for them** Definition in the second sentence: drugs 'the body has no need for'. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Legal Officer), Sep 2023.
2	**C**	**a magical process** The passage says the brain works 'not by a magical process'. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Legal Officer), Sep 2023.
3	**D**	**The brain can no longer evaluate the information as pleasure** Detail: 'Information ... still reaches the brain, but the brain is unable to evaluate and interpret it as pleasure'. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Legal Officer), Sep 2023.
4	**A**	**enlarge satisfaction and can be repeated indefinitely** Detail: the last sentence. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Legal Officer), Sep 2023.
5	**A**	**explanatory and cautionary** Tone: it explains a mechanism and warns of harm. Passage: GPSC CBRT (Legal Officer), Sep 2023.
6	**A**	**a serious, human-driven threat to the treatment of infections** Main idea: 'a slow-moving pandemic' driven 'less by nature than by human behaviour'. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
7	**C**	**Excessive use of vaccines** NOT question: vaccines are never mentioned. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
8	**D**	**is a worldwide threat that grows gradually** Vocabulary in context. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
9	**A**	**Because overcrowding, poor sanitation and demand for quick cures also drive it** Detail: the seventh sentence. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
10	**B**	**analytical and cautionary** Tone: explains causes and urges responsible action; not hopeless. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).

English drill: Comprehension: health and medicine passages

11	**B**	**officially recognised systems with both strengths and limitations** Main idea: balanced; the author weighs supporters and critics. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
12	**B**	**Acupuncture** NOT question: acupuncture is not listed. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
13	**A**	**chronic and lifestyle disorders** Detail: the third sentence. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
14	**D**	**The evidence for many remedies is thin and patients may delay effective treatment** Detail: the fifth sentence. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
15	**C**	**an integrated framework, backed by research and referral, is needed** Main idea: the last sentence. The balanced option is the GPSC answer. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
16	**D**	**a useful extension of local care with clear limits** Main idea: the last sentence. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
17	**A**	**perform a physical examination** Detail: it 'cannot examine an abdomen or listen to a chest'. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
18	**B**	**Older and less literate patients** Detail: the fifth sentence. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
19	**A**	**Follow-up visits and chronic illness management** Detail: the last sentence. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
20	**C**	**balanced and practical** Tone: acknowledges benefits and limits. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
21	**A**	**essential research that depends on ethical safeguards** Main idea: 'the bridge between laboratory discovery and bedside treatment', resting on trust. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
22	**B**	**understand the purpose, risks and benefits and may withdraw at any time** Definition in the fourth sentence. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
23	**C**	**Mandatory insurance for doctors** NOT question. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
24	**A**	**may be signed without real understanding** Vocabulary in context: technical language defeats the purpose. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).
25	**D**	**the welfare of the volunteer must always come first** Main idea: the last sentence. Passage: GPSC-style practice passage (2026 pattern).